MALLIKA SARABHAI, 68

Classical dancer



DANESH JASSAWALA

"Happiness for me is twofold: feeling fit and healthy and being able to jump out of bed wanting to face a new day, and doing something every day to bring light and a smile to someone. The thrill of a standing ovation and the acknowledgement and awards from certain institutions can bring a momentary gladness, but for me true happiness is making a difference in people's lives, using my voice for the voiceless, justice for the marginalised. That brings meaning to life. It makes one's presence on this planet meaningful. Well-being comes from loving and being loved. True lasting happiness comes from a sense of well-being, and that comes from a body and mind well looked after, and then using those for positive change. In today's cynical world, that might sound like a sanctimonious talk, but for me, it is true happiness."



DANESH JASSAWALA

ABHISHEK JAIN, 36

Hindi and Gujarati film director

"In today's information-loaded and tech-savvy world, what makes me happy is a new experience. Not information, but new knowledge, new wisdom, enlightenment... something we know is out there in the clutter, and amidst all of it, if I find a pearl in the form of knowledge, that gives me a lot of happiness. Otherwise, there are a lot of material things that do give happiness, but when I actually think about it, at the core of it all, a new challenge excites me more and gives me a certain adrenaline rush. Nothing is more gratifying than experiencing that moment of epiphany."

N.V. RAMA RAJU, 60

Managing Director, Jalavihar, Hyderabad

"The secret to happiness is to always express gratitude for what you have attained in life. Being a first-generation entrepreneur, what gives me immense joy is the journey of getting where I am today. It took a lot of sacrifice and perseverance... but happiness to me is enjoying life's uncertainties with the support of my family and friends. My success and balance sheet are defined by the friends I have. Doing whatever I can to the best of my abilities and sharing their struggles give me satisfaction. It is my way of expressing gratitude for having them in my life...and to be happy."

